

as well. Other than that, the device's excellent battery life, low price-tag and sturdy hardware made it the top choice in handheld consoles of that time.

One of the other well-known devices of that generation was the Atari Lynx, a 16-bit handheld game console released in September 1989 in North



Game Boy

America, and in Europe and Japan in 1990. The Lynx held the honour of being the world's first handheld console with a color display. In addition, the system pushed its ergonomic and user friendly keypad layout to its advantage, and made attempts to compete with the Game Boy.

Another portable device that gave the Lynx and Game Boy a run for their money was Sega's Game Gear, released in 1990. Unfortunately, despite its superior backlit-LED screen and low price, the console's short battery life, small game library and weak customer support from Sega pulled back the device, and the Game Gear was unable to surpass the Game Boy's sale. For that matter, neither the Lynx nor the Game

Gear was able to compete with the Game Boy's rugged make and low price tag, which meant that Nintendo, once again, occupied the top spot in the console market.

The fifth generation of video game consoles worked upon the achievements of all generations before, and laid the groundwork for the consoles that we do see today. So more on that in the next chapter. **d**